HEAT STRESS

BASIC RISK ASSESSMENT GUIDE FOR ALL PERSONNEL

This guide covers the main hazards from working in hot environments. **Read it. Know it. Follow it.**
If you feel unwell from the heat, **stop work and tell your Team Leader immediately.**

#	HAZARD	WHAT CAN HAPPEN	WHAT YOU DO
1	**Heat exhaustion**	You sweat, feel weak, dizzy, sick. You may faint. Can happen quickly.	✓ Drink water often - do not wait until thirsty ✓ Rest in shade or cool place ✓ Tell Team Leader if you feel weak or dizzy ✓ Remove helmet or heavy gear if safe to do so
2	**Heat stroke (EMERGENCY)**	Body temperature above 40°C. Confusion, seizures, organ damage. Life-threatening.	✓ Get help from Team Leader immediately ✓ Move to cool place at once ✓ Cool the body - water, ice, shade ✓ Drink water if conscious
3	**Dehydration**	Not enough water in body. Headache, muscle cramps, bad decisions, kidney problems.	✓ Drink water every 15-20 minutes ✓ Do not drink only when thirsty ✓ Salt loss matters - eat salty food ✓ Dark urine means you need more water
4	**Sunburn**	Sun burns your skin. Red, painful skin. Risk of skin damage and infection.	✓ Use sun cream SPF 30+ ✓ Cover skin - hat, long sleeves if possible ✓ Reapply cream every 2 hours ✓ Avoid sun during peak hours (11am-3pm)
5	**Heat cramps and rash**	Sudden painful muscle cramps. Red, itchy skin rash from sweat and heat.	✓ Stretch and massage cramped muscles ✓ Drink water and sports drinks with electrolytes ✓ Keep skin dry - change wet clothes ✓ Use powder to prevent rash on skin folds
6	**Poor thinking and reaction**	Heat makes you slow, confused, bad at decisions. You miss hazards. Accidents happen.	✓ Stop and rest if you feel confused ✓ Drink water and cool down ✓ Tell Team Leader if you cannot concentrate ✓ Never operate equipment if dizzy or confused
7	**PPE and body armour**	Heavy gear traps heat. Body armour, helmet, thick clothing make it worse. Heat builds up fast.	✓ Wear minimum PPE needed - ask Team Leader ✓ Remove gear when not needed ✓ Ventilate under armour - loosen straps ✓ Take more rest breaks with heavy gear
8	**Hot enclosed spaces**	Armouries, cabins, spaces below deck. Poor air, heat builds up. Dangerous very fast.	✓ Ventilate before entering ✓ Never lock doors - always have exit ✓ Take extra water breaks ✓ Work in pairs - never alone
9	**New to hot climate**	New team members not used to heat. Body not adjusted yet. Higher risk first 7-10 days.	✓ Limit heavy work for first week ✓ Drink more water than you think you need ✓ Rest more - do not push yourself ✓ Tell Team Leader if you feel unwell
10	**Night duties and travel**	Even at night, tropics stay hot. Travel in vehicles or boats. Long periods without rest or water.	✓ Drink water at night too ✓ Take breaks every 2 hours ✓ Drivers stop for cooling breaks ✓ Rest before night duty

STOP WORK – YOU HAVE THE RIGHT

If you or a colleague shows signs of heat illness, stop work immediately.

No one will be punished for stopping work due to heat. Tell your Team Leader. If they do not listen, contact the Group Compliance Director directly.

Full risk assessment: SM/HSE/RA/009 – Heat Stress v1.0
Related: Heat Stress SOP | SM/HSE/PRO/001 – Hazard ID & Risk Assessment
Questions? Contact the Group Compliance Director or QHSE Manager

YOUR WATCH. OUR STANDARD.
Assess. Report. Deliver.